

VEERSA INTER-EMPLOYEE TEAM CHESS TOURNAMENT

Tournament Rules and Regulations

Tournament Date	_____	Venue / Platform	_____
Reporting Time	_____	Match Start Time	_____
Chief Arbiter	_____	Organizing Board	_____
Final Team Size	3 to 6 players	Number of Rounds	_____

1. Tournament Format

The tournament is intended to promote healthy competition, teamwork and employee engagement. All participants are expected to maintain professional and respectful conduct throughout the event.

It will be played as a Swiss-system chess tournament, a non-elimination format where competitors play a set number of rounds.

- Before the event begins, the number of rounds is fixed (5-6).
- In each round, winners are paired with winners, and losers are paired with losers.
- You will never play the same person twice in the same tournament.
- The system ensures that players alternate between using White and Black pieces as evenly as possible.
- It also tracks how many White and Black games a player has had to balance color assignments in later rounds.
- The team with the highest total points at the end of the set number of rounds wins the event.

2. Team Composition and Board Order

2.1 Team Composition

- Each team will consist of three to six players.
- The final team size and number of boards per match will be decided after all employee nominations have been received.
- All registered team members will be active players. There will be no separate concept of reserve players.
- Every registered player will normally play in each team match on their assigned board.
- No player may be registered for more than one team.
- All players must be Veersa employees unless specifically approved by the Tournament Organizing Board.
- No new player may be added after the tournament begins, except in exceptional circumstances approved by the Tournament Organizing Board.

2.2 Board Order

- Each team must submit a fixed board sequence covering all registered players.
- The board order must be based on players' relative playing strength.
- The strongest player will be assigned to Board 1, the next strongest to Board 2, and so on.
- Where ratings are available, the rating system approved by the Tournament Organizing Board will be used.
- Ratings from different chess platforms will not be directly compared unless specifically approved.
- For unrated players, board order may be determined through internal qualification games, previous performance or known playing strength.
- Once submitted, the board sequence cannot be changed during the tournament except with the approval of the Tournament Organizing Board.
- Players cannot exchange or rearrange their normal board positions.

3. Player Unavailability and Replacement

- If a player is unavailable due to sickness or another genuine exceptional reason, the team may request a replacement.
- A replacement is not automatic and must be approved by the Tournament Organizing Board before the match.
- Only a player assigned to a lower-ranked board than the unavailable player may be considered as a replacement.
- A higher-ranked player cannot move down to replace a lower-ranked player.
- The approved replacement player will play both their own assigned game and the additional game on the unavailable player's board.
- A player may play a maximum of two games in one team match and cannot replace more than one unavailable player.

3.1 Approval Process

- The team captain must submit the replacement request to the Tournament Organizing Board as early as possible.
- Wherever possible, the request should be submitted at least one day before the scheduled match.
- In a last-minute medical or genuine emergency, the Board may consider a late request at its discretion.
- The request must identify the unavailable player, reason for unavailability, proposed replacement player and both registered board positions.
- The Board may approve or reject the request and may seek supporting information where appropriate.
- The Board may reject a request if it believes the replacement is being used for strategic advantage or does not meet tournament rules.
- The decision of the Tournament Organizing Board will be final.

3.2 Games Played by One Player on Two Boards

- If a replacement is approved, the two games will be played one after the other and not simultaneously.
- The player will normally first play the game on their own assigned board.
- After the first game is completed and the result is reported to the arbiter, the player will play the additional game on the unavailable player's board.
- The Tournament Organizing Board or Chief Arbiter may change the order of the two games for scheduling reasons.
- Both games will be treated as separate games and will carry independent board points.
- The normal tournament time control will apply separately to each game, and the player will receive the full allotted time for both games.
- The opponent scheduled for the second game must remain available until the first game is completed.
- The second game must begin within five minutes of completion and reporting of the first game, unless otherwise directed by the arbiter.
- No player will be penalized for waiting for an approved replacement to complete the first game.
- The substitution must not be used strategically to delay a match, observe an opponent's play or gain an unfair advantage.

3.3 Walkover

- If a replacement request is not approved, the affected board will be treated as a walkover loss.
- If no replacement request is submitted, the affected board will be treated as a walkover loss.
- If no eligible lower-ranked player is available, the affected board will be treated as a walkover loss.
- If the final-board player is unavailable, that board will be a walkover because no lower-ranked player is available.
- The opposing team will receive one board point for the walkover.
- The remaining games in the team match will continue normally.

4. Time Control

- All games will be played at 10 minutes per player with no increment (10+0).
- The tournament will therefore be conducted as a blitz chess tournament.
- Players must press the clock after completing every move.
- A move is considered completed when the player presses the clock.
- Any change to the time control will be communicated before the tournament begins.

5. General Rules

- FIDE Laws of Chess will apply unless specifically modified by these tournament regulations.
- Tournament-specific rules stated in this document will take precedence for this event.
- Players must behave respectfully toward opponents, teammates, arbiters and organizers.
- The decision of the Chief Arbiter will be final after completion of the applicable appeal process.

6. Scoring System

6.1 Individual Board Points

Result	Board Points
Win	1
Draw	0.5
Loss	0
Walkover win	1
Walkover loss	0

The maximum board points available in a match will equal the final number of players and boards decided by the Tournament Organizing Board.

6.2 Team Match Points

- Team with more board points: 2 match points
- Teams with equal board points: 1 match point each
- Team with fewer board points: 0 match points

6.3 Examples

- For a five-board match, 3-2 is a team win and 2.5-2.5 is a draw.
- For a six-board match, 3.5-2.5 is a team win and 3-3 is a draw.

7. Colours

- The team named first in the fixture will have White on odd-numbered boards and Black on even-numbered boards.
- The team named second will have Black on odd-numbered boards and White on even-numbered boards.
- The pairing system or Tournament Organizing Board may reverse colours to maintain reasonable colour balance.
- In knockout tie-break matches, colours will be reversed wherever applicable.

8. Legal Moves and Game Progression

- Every player must make a legal move on their turn.
- A move is completed by physically moving the piece and pressing the clock.
- Players must use the same hand to move the piece and press the clock.
- Players must not use both hands to complete a move, including castling, promotion or capturing.
- A player claiming an illegal move must pause the clock and call the arbiter immediately.

- Players should not continue after making a claim unless instructed by the arbiter.

8.1 Illegal Moves

- An illegal move is considered completed once the player presses the clock.
- For the first completed illegal move, the player receives a warning and one minute is added to the opponent's clock.
- A second completed illegal move by the same player results in loss of the game.
- The game will be a draw instead if the opponent cannot possibly checkmate by any legal sequence of moves.
- The arbiter will determine whether a move qualifies as illegal.

9. Touch-Move Rule

- If a player deliberately touches one of their own pieces with the intention of moving it, they must move that piece if it has a legal move.
- If a player deliberately touches an opponent's piece with the intention of capturing it, they must capture that piece if a legal capture is possible.
- A player may adjust a misplaced piece by clearly saying “adjust”, “I adjust” or “J'adoube” before touching it.
- Saying “adjourn” does not qualify as a declaration to adjust a piece.
- If a touched piece cannot legally be moved or captured, the player may make another legal move.
- Merely touching a piece that has no legal move is not automatically a completed illegal move.
- The opponent must raise a touch-move claim before making their own move.

10. End of the Game

Checkmate: A player wins by checkmating the opponent's king.

Resignation: A player may resign at any time. The opponent is declared the winner.

Stalemate: The game is drawn if the player to move has no legal move and their king is not in check.

Dead Position: The game is drawn when neither player can possibly checkmate by any legal sequence of moves.

Draw by Agreement: Players may agree to a draw only after both have completed at least 20 moves, unless the arbiter permits an earlier draw in exceptional circumstances.

Threefold Repetition: A player may claim a draw if the same position has appeared at least three times with the same player to move and the same legal possibilities.

Fivefold Repetition: The game is automatically drawn if the same position occurs five times.

Fifty-Move Rule: A player may claim a draw if each player has completed at least 50 moves without a pawn move or capture.

Seventy-Five-Move Rule: The game is automatically drawn if each player has completed 75 moves without a pawn move or capture, unless the final move results in checkmate.

11. Time Violations

- Each player has 10 minutes to complete the entire game.
- If a player's time expires, that player loses the game.
- The game is drawn if the opponent cannot possibly checkmate by any legal sequence of moves.
- A player claiming that the opponent's time has expired should pause the clock and call the arbiter.

12. Reporting Time, Late Arrival and Walkovers

- Teams must report before the scheduled match time.
- Clocks may be started at the scheduled match time irrespective of whether all players are present.

- A late player may join using the time remaining on their clock.
- If a player does not arrive before their clock expires, they lose by walkover and the opponent receives one board point.
- If both players on a board are absent until both clocks expire, no board point will be awarded unless the Chief Arbiter decides otherwise.
- Repeated late arrival may result in additional penalties.

13. Fair Play and Ethics

- Players must play their own games without external assistance.
- Players, teammates and spectators must remain silent in the playing area.
- No one may suggest moves, strategies or clock-related information during an ongoing game.
- Players must not distract or disturb opponents.
- Mobile phones and smart devices must remain silent and away from the playing area.
- Use of a mobile phone during a game may result in loss unless authorised by the arbiter.
- Players must not analyse ongoing games in the playing area.
- Team captains must not interfere with ongoing games.
- Cheating or attempted cheating may result in loss of game, loss of match, removal or disqualification, and further action under Veersa policies where applicable.
- Players must report results immediately after completion and reset or pack the chess set as instructed.

14. Online Play Regulations

This section applies only to matches officially conducted online.

14.1 Approved Platform and Account

- Online matches will be played on Lichess using official tournament links.
- Players must use their registered Lichess account and may not use multiple accounts.
- Players should have completed at least 15 rated 10+0 games before the tournament; the Board may waive this for beginners or verified employees.

14.2 Prohibited Assistance

- Chess engines
- Opening books
- Analysis boards
- Move-suggestion software
- External applications offering chess advice
- Assistance from teammates or spectators
- Using another person to play the game
- Communicating about the ongoing game

14.3 Internet, Device and Fair Play Review

- Players are responsible for a stable internet connection and functioning device.
- If a player disconnects, the game continues according to Lichess platform rules.
- Personal internet or device failure does not automatically justify a restart or replay.
- If Lichess experiences a confirmed platform-wide failure, the organizers may cancel, restart or reschedule affected games.
- The organizers may review games using Lichess Fair Play tools and other evidence.
- The Chief Arbiter's decision regarding fair play violations will be final.

15. Role of the Arbiter

- The arbiter will supervise matches, apply rules, resolve disputes, verify results, monitor conduct and investigate fair play concerns.
- Players must call the arbiter instead of attempting to resolve serious disputes themselves.
- Possible penalties include warning, time adjustment, loss of game, loss of board or match points, removal from a round or disqualification.

16. Appeals

- A team captain may appeal an arbiter's decision to the Chief Arbiter within 10 minutes of the conclusion of the relevant game or match.
- The appeal must clearly explain the disputed decision.
- Games must not be replayed or restarted without approval.
- The Chief Arbiter's decision will be final.
- Where the Chief Arbiter made the original decision, the appeal may be referred to the Tournament Organizing Board.

17. Tournament Flow

17.1 Swiss League Stage

- The league stage will use the Swiss System.
- Every team will normally participate in every round.
- Teams will be paired against opponents with the same or similar scores, while avoiding repeat pairings wherever possible.
- The tournament will consist of five or six Swiss rounds; the final number will depend on participation.
- Once officially published, pairings cannot be changed except by the Chief Arbiter.

17.2 Match Results

- The team captain must verify and report the final board-wise result.
- Both captains should confirm the result before leaving the playing area.
- Incorrectly reported results must be brought to the organizers' attention immediately.
- Results may not be changed after the next round is paired unless approved by the Chief Arbiter.

18. League Standings and Tie-Breaks

1. Total match points
2. Total board points
3. Buchholz score
4. Direct encounter, where applicable
5. Number of team match wins
6. Sonneborn-Berger score, where supported
7. Blitz tie-break match
8. Armageddon game or draw of lots, if still required

19. Qualification and Knockout Stage

- The top four teams after the Swiss league stage will qualify for the knockout stage, unless the Board announces a different number before the tournament begins.
- Semi-finals will be seeded as Rank 1 versus Rank 4 and Rank 2 versus Rank 3.

- The winners will play the final, and the losing semi-finalists will play the third-place match.

19.1 Knockout Tie-Break Procedure

- If a knockout match is tied, teams will play another match at 5+3 with colours reversed.
- If it remains tied, each team will nominate one player for an Armageddon game.
- White will receive 5 minutes and must win; Black will receive 4 minutes and wins the tie with a draw.
- The Chief Arbiter may revise the tie-break time control before the tournament begins and will communicate it to all teams.

20. Withdrawal and Forfeiture

- A team unable to participate in a round must notify the organizers as early as possible.
- Failure to appear without notice may result in match forfeiture.
- The Tournament Organizing Board will decide how completed results of a withdrawn team are treated.
- A team repeatedly failing to field the required number of players may be removed from the tournament.

21. Captains' Responsibilities

- Submitting team registration and fixed board order.
- Ensuring players report on time.
- Submitting replacement requests where necessary.
- Communicating with organizers and reporting match results.
- Raising appeals where required.
- Ensuring team compliance with fair play rules.
- Not advising players during an ongoing game.

22. Final Authority

Situations not specifically covered in these rules will be decided by the Chief Arbiter and Tournament Organizing Board in accordance with FIDE Laws of Chess, fairness to all teams, practical tournament requirements and the spirit of the Veersa employee tournament. The Tournament Organizing Board may make reasonable administrative changes before the tournament begins, and any material change will be communicated to all participants.